

Keep a bottle or two of distilled water handy. We use distilled water since it will ensure that your loop is cleaned with a clean liquid with minimal impurities. After you're ready with the above setup, drain the fluid from the reservoir into a bucket or bottle. Pour distilled water into the reservoir and start the pump so that it flows into the custom loop. While you're pouring distilled water, make sure you're draining the reservoir as well. Slowly you'll start noticing that the coolant's colour becomes clearer. You should keep in mind that you don't want the reservoir to run out of fluid, whether distilled water or coolant, since air intake into the pump can damage it. Once you notice that the fluid inside the loop has become completely clear, you can stop the pumping process. The fluid might still be slightly cloudy because of the residue from the coolant and it will only go after the reservoir and tubing has been cleaned. At this stage, you should start draining all the fluid from the system. If you don't have a drain valve then you should invest in a syringe with a long tube to suck out the fluid from the reservoir manually. Some fluid will still be sitting in the loop and radiator. The only way to get them down to the reservoir is to tilt the case a little here and there. Later, you can simply remove the tubes from the fittings and drain them cautiously.

Cleaning

If your custom loop cleaning cycle isn't frequent, you should be prepared for hours of washing and scrubbing every part. Based on the type of coolant you're using; the amount of residue or gunk formation will vary. However, there's no escaping it. You will see discolouration occurring as your coolant near a year of usage that will take away the aesthetic of your custom loop system. To start off, you need to decide what you want to clean. Whether you want to replace the fluid, or clean the tubing or want to do a deep cleaning of all the parts. A fluid change won't require much of pain since all you need to do is drain the existing coolant by following the above-mentioned draining process and finally pouring in the new coolant. A deep cleaning would involve the usage of chemicals usually bundled in a cleaning kit to flush and clean the tubing along with some rigorous cleaning of the parts. We'll start off with the regular cleaning method which is enough if you frequently clean your custom loop.

Once you've drained your system and cleaned the tubing with distilled water, you can disassemble the parts to clean them individually. Be very careful when you're removing the tubes from the water blocks since some lurking fluid might suddenly pour in out of nowhere. Hence, you should